A TABLETOP GAME FOR STARSHIP YARD

SECOND WATCH

The core book. Design a starship, take command, and play the missions the famous crews never saw.

PLAYTEST EDITION · NOVEMBER 2026

STARSHIP YARD PRESENTS

A TABLETOP GAME

EVERY LEGEND HAD A FLEET BEHIND IT.



When the famous ship went missing, someone went looking. When the battle ended, someone pulled the survivors from the wreckage. **Second Watch** is a game about those captains.

DESIGN IT

Build your ship deck by deck in Starship Yard.

PRINT IT

Every number on its record sheet comes from your design.

COMMAND IT

Two dice, one roll, and the call is yours, Captain.

SECOND WATCH

1 ADMIRAL · 2–5 CAPTAINS
TWO SIX-SIDED DICE

CONTENTS

1 What is Second Watch?

2 Playing in ten minutes

3 Your ship

4 Captains and crews

5 Missions

6 Skirmish

7 For the Admiral

A Appendix

WHAT IS SECOND WATCH?

Every Star Trek series follows a legendary crew. But for every famous starship, hundreds more were out there doing the galaxy's work: the convoy that reached the colony a week after the crisis, the patrol that found the wreckage, the picket ship holding a quiet border while the great battle happened somewhere else. Nobody filmed them.

Second Watch is a tabletop game about those ships, and you are their captains.

You design your ship from the keel up in **Starship Yard**: its hull, its systems, every deck, laboratory, turbolift and transporter room. You watch it built and launched. Then you print its record sheet and bring it to the table, where one player, **the Admiral**, hands your task force its orders. Canon events happen around you, like the weather. The famous crews stay offstage. What you do in the aftermath is the story.

WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT

- **Your ship is your character sheet.** Every number you roll comes from the design. A science vessel with stellar cartography gets better at surveys; an escort without a sickbay struggles in a medical emergency. Choices you made in the shipyard show up at the table.
- **You are the captain.** You decide what your crew attempts, and how much risk to take. Your crew are skilled professionals at their posts; the dice say whether they pull it off.
- **One roll does everything.** Two six-sided dice plus a bonus from your sheet, against a target number. You can learn it in ten minutes.
- **Canon is the weather.** Campaigns are set in the gaps around events you already know, from the Xindi attack on Earth to the Burn. You will never stop Wolf 359, but you might be the ship that brings its survivors home.

WHAT A SESSION LOOKS LIKE

A session runs two to three hours. The Admiral reads the orders. The captains plan, then play through three to five scenes: a navigation hazard, a survey, a standoff, an away mission. Each scene comes down to a captain's choice and a roll. If talking fails, the ships go on the table for a skirmish. At the end comes a debrief: credits, reputation, and the consequences that carry into the next mission.

WHAT YOU NEED

- A ship for each captain, built in Starship Yard, and its printed record sheet (two pages)
- Three six-sided dice per player, and pencils
- One person to be the Admiral (or the solo tables in Chapter 5)

- For battles: a table about 3 × 3 ft, a ruler in inches, and miniatures or tokens. Starship Yard exports your ship as 3D print files; the 50 mm size suits the table.

HOW THIS BOOK IS ORGANIZED

1. **What is Second Watch?** You are here.
2. **Playing in ten minutes.** The core roll, with an example of play.
3. **Your ship.** How Starship Yard turns a design into the numbers on your record sheet.
4. **Captains and crews.** Command styles, Resolve, Renown, crew quality, and the four ways to play.
5. **Missions.** Scenes, requirements, away teams, and mission tables.
6. **Skirmish.** Ship-to-ship combat on the table.
7. **For the Admiral.** Campaigns, power levels, Background Ops, and a ready-to-run first mission.
8. **Appendix.** Quick reference, the Generic setting, and printable sheets.

New players need Chapters 1 to 3. The Admiral should read the whole book, starting with Chapter 7.

PLAYING IN TEN MINUTES

Everything in Second Watch uses one roll. Learn it here, then watch it in play.

THE CORE ROLL

Every uncertain action is one roll: **2d6 + department rating + crew quality + command bonus, meet or beat the target number.** Department ratings run from −2 to +4 and come off the record sheet. Crew quality is +0 to +2. The command bonus is +1 when the department is one of the captain's command style strengths.

TARGET	DIFFICULTY	EXAMPLE
6	Routine	Scan a planet with working sensors
8	Standard	Hit a ship at medium range
10	Hard	Beam out an away team through an ion storm
12	Heroic	Restart a warp core that has lost containment

- **Advantage:** roll 3d6, keep the best two. You get it when the ship has a facility that fits the job (stellar cartography for a star survey, a battle bridge when the main bridge is down).
- **Disadvantage:** roll 3d6, keep the worst two. You get it when a required system is missing or damaged. Advantage and disadvantage cancel out.
- **Critical success:** a natural 12 (double six). The action succeeds and adds one benefit: an extra hit, a clue, a crew bonus.
- **Complication:** a natural 2 (double one). The action fails and the Admiral draws a complication (Mission tables).
- **Pushing:** after a failed roll, the captain can push by marking 1 Stress on the ship (in a fight) or spending 1 Resolve (anywhere) to reroll.

The bonus cap. However many bonuses stack up, the total added to a roll is never more than **+4**. Without the cap, a Veteran crew in its best department would beat a Hard target on any roll. With it, even the best-fit ship still fails a Heroic task more often than not.

Why 2d6. Two dice make a bell curve: 7 is common and 2 or 12 are rare. Each +1 is worth more near the middle, so the ship's design matters more than luck; results are predictable enough to plan around; and doubles give critical successes and complications without a separate roll. All you need are ordinary six-sided dice.

BONUS	BEAT 6	BEAT 8	BEAT 10	BEAT 12
+0	72%	42%	17%	3%
+2	92%	72%	42%	17%
+4	97% (a double one always fails)	92%	72%	42%

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Three friends are playing The Salvage Line (Chapter 7). Dana is the Admiral. Sam captains the Kestrel, *a science vessel, with the Explorer command style. Jo captains the* Ardent, *an escort, with the Tactician style. Both crews are Green (+0).*

Dana (Admiral): You drop out of warp at the edge of the Wolf 359 debris field. Hulls drift in every direction, and some of them still have power. Starfleet wants three flight recorders. Sam, the *Kestrel* is closest to the densest wreckage. How do you approach?

Sam: Slowly. I want my science team mapping which wrecks are still live before we go in. That's a Science roll, right?

Dana: Science 8. It's a standard target.

Sam checks the sheet. *Kestrel*'s Science rating is +3, the crew adds +0, and Explorer gives +1 to Science. That's +4, which is also the cap. The ship has stellar cartography, a facility that fits the job, so Sam rolls with **advantage**: three dice, keeping the best two.

Sam rolls 2, 5 and 4, and keeps 5 + 4 = 9. Adding +4 makes 13, which beats 8.

Dana: Your sensors light up the field like a map. You find the first recorder, and a safe lane in. *(The scene succeeds. Sam marks nothing.)*

Later, at the edge of the field, a Ferengi salvage ship is cutting up a Starfleet hull.

Jo: The *Ardent* moves in between them and the wreck. I hail them: this is a restricted zone, and they need to leave.

Dana: That's a standoff. Command 9, or Diplomacy 9 if you'd rather talk them round.

Jo looks at the sheet. As an escort, *Ardent*'s Diplomacy is −1, but its Command is +1. Tactician doesn't add to either, so Jo picks Command at +1.

Jo rolls 3 and 3. That's 6 + 1 = 7, which fails.

Dana: The Ferengi captain laughs. "Legal salvage, Captain. Unless you plan to shoot us over scrap?" Their weapons are warming up.

Jo: I'm not letting this turn into a fight. I spend a Resolve and push.

Jo marks one of the captain's three Resolve boxes and rerolls. This time it's 5 and 4: 9 + 1 = 10, a success.

Jo: I lock weapons, very visibly, and tell them the next ship through here will be a lot less patient than me.

Dana: They power down and back off, grumbling. You keep the hull, and you didn't fire a shot.

What this example shows:

- The Admiral describes the situation and names a target number; the **captain chooses the approach**, and the approach decides which department rolls.
- The **ship's design** decided the odds: the *Kestrel*'s stellar cartography gave it advantage, and the *Ardent*'s weak Diplomacy pushed Jo toward Command.
- **Resolve** is how a captain insists. Three per mission makes each one a real decision.
- Failure moves the story along instead of stopping it: the first failed roll turned the standoff tense rather than ending it.

YOUR SHIP

Your ship is the most important character you will play. Everything on its record sheet is calculated by Starship Yard from your design, so the way you build it is the way it plays.

FROM SHIPYARD TO RECORD SHEET

Starship Yard takes a ship through five stages: **Shape** (rough out the hull in blocks), **Refine** (size, hull finish, era, name and registry), **Systems** (role, weapons, shields, and engines), **Decks** (the chief engineer lays out every deck, with your changes) and **Launch** (assembly, 3D printing, and the record sheet).

Some choices matter more at the table than others:

- **Size** sets how many hits your ship can take, how slowly it turns, and how many systems boxes it has. Bigger ships are tougher but clumsier.
- **Mission role** shapes your departments. An Explorer is better at diplomacy; an Escort is worse.
- **Facilities** are your advantage sources. Every facility that fits a scene (stellar cartography for a survey, an isolation ward for an outbreak, diplomatic suites for negotiations) lets you roll three dice and keep the best two.
- **Weapons and shields** decide how you fight, but they cost Power and credits that could have gone elsewhere.
- **Structural stress** sets your Stress track. An overgunned frame hits hard, but it buckles if you keep pushing it.

When the Admiral sets a **power level** (Chapter 7), Starship Yard shows a live budget meter while you build, so you know whether the ship fits the campaign before you print it.

READING THE SHEET

Page 1 of the record sheet is the ship: hull, shields, power, speed, weapons, systems and departments. Page 2 is the people: the captain, the crew, and the profile you are playing. **Roll bonus** is the number you add to your dice. It already includes your department rating, crew quality and command bonus, capped at +4.

SECOND WATCH · EXPLORER TYPE · SIZE L · GALAXY ERA · 2360S

U.S.S. ENDEAVOUR NCC-82410

1,298 FC
free build



HULL

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

DEFLECTOR SHIELDS

Fore	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐
Aft	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐
Port	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐
Stbd	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

SHIP

Power per round	**15**
Speed	**6"**
Turn 45°	**every 3"**
FTL	**Warp 6.8 cruise / 9.4 max**
Crew	**816 + 490 civilians**
Stress	☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐
Morale	☐☐☐☐☐
Supplies	☐☐☐☐☐☐

WEAPONS

WEAPON	ATTACKS	DMG	RANGE	ARC
Phaser array battery	4	2	18"	All-round
Photon torpedo launcher (fore)	1	4	24"	Forward 90°
Photon torpedo launcher (aft)	1	4	24"	Aft 90°

Hit on 2d6 + Tactical: 7+ short (first third of range), 8+ medium, 10+ long. Torpedoes ignore 1 shield point. Each weapon fired costs 1 Power (spinal gun 3).

SYSTEMS

Bridge	☐☐☐
Engineering	☐☐☐
Weapons	☐☐☐
Shields	☐☐☐
Sensors	☐☐☐
Life support	☐☐☐
Transporters	☐☐☐
Small craft	☐☐☐
Sickbay	☐☐☐

All boxes marked = offline. Damage control: 2d6 + Engineering + Repairs, 9+ clears one box.

DEPARTMENTS

DEPARTMENT	RATING	ROLL BONUS
Command	+2	**+2**
Helm	+1	**+1**
Tactical	+1	**+1**
Science ★	+4	**+4**
Engineering	+4	**+4**
Medical	+1	**+1**
Operations	+3	**+3**
Diplomacy ★	+3	**+4**

Roll bonus includes Green crew (+0) and +1 command bonus on ★ departments. Total bonus never exceeds +4.

The rest of this chapter explains each number on the sheet and where it comes from.

EVERY NUMBER ON THE SHEET

Every number on the sheet is calculated by Starship Yard from the design, so changing the ship in the app changes how it plays. The Explorer template is the worked example.

STAT	WHAT IT DOES	HOW THE APP DERIVES IT	EXPLORER
Size class	Sets turning and system boxes	S under 150 m, M 150–349 m, L 350–599 m, XL 600 m+	L
Hull	Damage boxes before the ship is lost	Cube root of mass in tonnes ÷ 6, minimum 6	29
Shields	Points per facing (fore, aft, port, starboard)	Square root of shield output in TW ÷ 2	9 each
Power	Points to spend each turn	Core output in TW ÷ 40	15
Speed	Inches moved per turn at full impulse	8 − 2 × log10(mass ÷ 100,000) + impulse blocks, 2 to 10	6
Stress	Overload boxes; full means a breakdown	12 − structural stress % ÷ 10, minimum 3	8
Morale	Crew boxes for Adventure	Morale rating ÷ 20, 1 to 5	4
Supplies	Mission endurance	6, or endurance months ÷ 3 on Generic ships	6

Weapons. Each weapon line has attacks, damage, range and firing arc:

WEAPON	ATTACKS	DAMAGE	RANGE	ARC
Beam battery (one per 3 phasers or beams)	1	2	18"	All-round for arrays; forward 180° for banks and cannons
Torpedo launcher	1 per launcher	4	24"	Forward 90° or aft 90°, matching the torpedo rooms the engineer placed
Spinal gun (Generic)	1	8	30"	Forward 30°
Mass driver (Generic)	1 per 3 turrets	3	24"	All-round

Departments are the ratings the crew rolls with (−2 to +4):

DEPARTMENT	SOURCE IN THE DESIGN
Command	+1 base, +1 battle bridge, +1 auxiliary control
Helm	+2 at speed 8+, +1 at speed 6–7, −1 at speed 3 or less
Tactical	Tactical rating compared to hull size, +1 armory
Science	Science rating ÷ 120, up to +4
Engineering	+1 base, +1 damage control, +1 fabrication shops, +1 if power margin is over 20%
Medical	+1 ICU, +1 isolation ward, +1 medical hologram, −1 if casualty response is over 60 s
Operations	Transporters and small craft
Diplomacy	+1 diplomatic suites, +1 Ten Forward or lounge, +1 Explorer role, −1 Escort role

Systems track. Nine systems each get 2 boxes (S and M), 3 (L) or 4 (XL): Bridge, Engineering, Weapons, Shields, Sensors, Life support, Transporters, Small craft, Sickbay. A system with every box marked is offline; rolls that need it take disadvantage or fail outright.

CAPTAINS AND CREWS

In Adventure, each player is the captain of their own ship. A mission runs as **Orders → Transit → 3 to 5 Scenes → Resolution → Debrief**, about 90 minutes. The Admiral delivers the orders and runs the debrief, in character if the table enjoys it.

Captains. The captain is the only character a player keeps. In each scene the captain gives the order (who acts, how, and at what risk) and the player rolls for that department. The crew carry it out. A good captain's skill is in choosing which department to send, and when to spend Resolve.

Command style. Each captain picks one style. It gives +1 (the command bonus) to its two departments and one ability usable once per mission.

STYLE	COMMAND BONUS	ONCE PER MISSION
Explorer	Science, Diplomacy	Turn a failed Survey or First contact roll into a partial success with a clue
Tactician	Tactical, Helm	Before a Skirmish, place your ship anywhere in your deployment zone after seeing the enemy
Diplomat	Diplomacy, Command	Make a hostile party pause for one scene to talk
Engineer	Engineering, Operations	Bring one offline system back with 1 box clear
Healer	Medical, Command	Recover 2 Morale boxes
Maverick	Helm, Command	Turn disadvantage into advantage on one roll

Resolve. A captain starts each mission with 3 Resolve. Spend 1 to reroll any failed roll, or to add +1 after seeing the dice. Resolve does not carry over.

Renown and Command traits. At each debrief, the Admiral awards 1 Renown for a completed mission, plus 1 for a hard choice made well or a canon event handled with credit. Every 3 Renown buys one Command trait (up to 5):

- **Steady hand:** once per scene, ignore a complication.
- **Inspiring:** Morale cannot drop below 1 while you are aboard.
- **Old hand:** +1 Resolve per mission.
- **Fleet contacts:** once per mission, call in one favor from another ship or starbase.
- **Specialist:** pick a third department for your command bonus.
- **Reputation precedes you:** advantage on the first Diplomacy or Command roll against anyone who has heard of you.

Crew quality. The crew is the ship's own stat, not a set of characters. Every roll on that ship adds its crew quality:

TIER	BONUS	HOW IT CHANGES
Green	+0	New ships and new crews start here (the Admiral may start a Capital-level or higher campaign at Seasoned)
Seasoned	+1	After 3 completed missions
Veteran	+2	After 6 more completed missions

The crew drops one tier if the ship is lost and rebuilt, or if Morale hits 0 during a mission. A Veteran crew transferred whole to a new ship keeps its tier, but this costs 2 Reputation with fleet command.

Task force play. With more than one captain, the group plays as a task force, one ship per player. The Admiral gives the task force one set of orders and names a senior captain, who breaks ties. Each scene is aimed at one ship, and the spotlight rotates. Another ship can **assist** if it is within range and its rating in that department is +1 or better; the rolling ship gets +1. Ships can split up to take separate scenes in the same mission.

Bridge play (one ship). One player is the captain; the others are department heads of their choice (First officer, Helm, Tactical, Science, Engineering, Medical, Operations). Players who would rather not take a post pick up a role card each mission, as on away teams.

- **The captain sets the course.** The captain picks the approach to each scene and keeps the command style, Resolve and Renown.
- **Department heads own their department.** When a roll uses your department, you make it and you choose how. You get +1 (the post bonus) in place of the command bonus, 2 Resolve per mission, and one post ability per mission: Helm (an evasive maneuver cancels one hit), Tactical (one shot ignores 2 shield points), Science (ask the Admiral one yes-or-no question about the scene), Engineering (clear one systems box), Medical (recover 1 Morale), Operations (move an away team one extra time in a scene), First officer (give another player your Resolve).
- **Disagreement is allowed.** A department head may advise against an order once per scene. If the captain overrules and the roll fails, the captain marks 1 Stress or 1 Resolve; if the advice is taken and works, the department head earns 1 Renown.
- **Rotating command (optional).** The captain's chair passes clockwise each mission. The ship and the crew quality stay the same.

Joint away teams. Away teams can mix crew from several ships.

- **Who goes.** A captain can beam down in person, or the player picks up a one-mission role card (Security chief, Science officer, Medic, Engineer, Diplomat) and plays that away lead instead.
- **What each ship contributes.** Each ship sends its lead plus up to 4 crew, limited by its transporters and shuttles. A roll uses the department rating and crew quality of the ship whose lead is acting.
- **Who is in charge.** The joint team names one overall leader, the senior officer present.

- **The ships stay in play.** Players whose leads stay aboard handle transport, sensors, cover fire and the fast exit. Away scenes and ship scenes alternate.

Frontier play (small crews). For ships with a crew of 2 to 20, every crew member is a character. Each player makes one, with a role (Pilot, Mechanic, Medic, Muscle, Face, Captain) and three skills: +2 in one department and +1 in two others. A roll is 2d6 + the ship's department rating + the acting character's skill, with the +4 cap. Crew quality is not used. Each character has 3 Resolve per mission and earns Renown like a captain.

Armada play (a fleet that cannot replace losses). The captains share three fleet resources, each starting at 10 boxes:

- **Fuel.** Each Transit costs 1 per ship. At 0, ships can only move with the fleet's tankers.
- **Food.** Each mission costs 1 per 3 ships. At 0, mark 1 Morale on every ship per mission.
- **Survivors.** The civilians and crew the fleet protects, in thousands. A lost ship costs boxes equal to its size (S 1, M 2, L 3, XL 4). At 0, the campaign is lost.

New ships cannot be bought. Repairs cost Fuel instead of FC (1 Fuel per 3 Hull boxes or 1 systems box). Missions win back resources instead of credits.

FOUR WAYS TO PLAY

Campaign profiles. Before the first session, the Admiral picks one profile. They share the core roll, the record sheet and the missions; they differ in who the players are.

PROFILE	FEELS LIKE	PLAYERS ARE	CREW
Fleet	Trek's background ships	Captains, one ship each, as a task force	A ship stat (Green, Seasoned, Veteran)
Bridge	One ship's senior staff	One captain plus department heads, sharing one ship	A ship stat; department heads lead it
Frontier	Small-crew sci-fi, Firefly-scale	The whole named crew of one small ship	Every crew member is a character
Armada	Last-fleet survival	Captains of a fleet that cannot replace losses	A ship stat; fuel, food and people are scarce

The Star Trek skin defaults to Fleet or Bridge. Frontier and Armada are made for the Generic skin, but any profile works with either.

Group size. The sweet spot is one Admiral and 2–3 players. Four or five still works if scenes split up. At six or more, run two task forces or add a second Admiral as squadron commander. In Skirmish, add one enemy ship per two player ships.

MISSIONS

Mission requirements. Every mission lists what it needs:

- **Required systems** (for example: long-range sensors, transporters, sickbay). A missing one makes every scene that uses it roll with disadvantage; a missing critical one makes the mission impossible until the ship is refit.
- **Helpful facilities** (stellar cartography, diplomatic suites, a captain's yacht). Each one the ship has gives advantage on the matching scene.
- **Crew minimum.** Some missions need a crew count, such as an evacuation that needs room for 2,000 people.

Scene types. The Admiral frames each scene; the captain picks which department acts. A scene succeeds on one success, or needs 2–3 successes before 3 failures for big moments.

SCENE	DEPARTMENT ROLLED	WHAT THE SHIP'S DESIGN CHANGES
Navigation hazard	Helm	Speed, FTL rating, deflector
Survey or anomaly	Science	Labs, cartography, astrometrics, sensor rating
First contact or negotiation	Diplomacy or Command	Diplomatic suites, Ten Forward, Explorer role
Medical emergency	Medical	Sickbay size, ICU, isolation ward, medical hologram
Engineering crisis	Engineering	Power margin, damage control, Jefferies tube coverage
Away team	Operations or Tactical	Transporter rooms, shuttles, security
Standoff or chase	Tactical or Helm	Weapons, shields; may turn into a Skirmish
Long haul	Command	Supplies, Morale, endurance, holodecks and recreation

Away teams. Each personnel transporter moves 6 people per scene; each shuttle moves 4 and can reach places transporters cannot. If the captain leads the away team, the command bonus applies to the away team's rolls instead of the ship's, and the first officer runs the ship at +0.

Supplies and Morale. Each Transit and each long scene costs 1 Supply. At 0 Supplies, mark 1 Morale per scene. Mark a Morale box to push a failed crew roll. At 0 Morale, the crew demands to return to base.

Turning a scene into a fight. Any Standoff that fails can become a Skirmish on the table, using the same record sheet. Damage taken carries back into the mission.

BUILDING A MISSION

Roll three dice to build a mission in a minute: one for the job, one for the place, one for the twist. The Admiral's table in Starship Yard (Launch → Second Watch → Run a mission) does this on screen and rolls each scene.

D6	MISSION	PLACE	TWIST
1	Survey an uncharted system	Gas giant with unstable moons	An old distress call is still repeating
2	Deliver medical supplies	Colony under quarantine	The cargo is not what the manifest says
3	Negotiate a treaty	Neutral station between two powers	One delegate is an impostor
4	Rescue a disabled ship	Ion storm or nebula	The survivors do not want rescuing
5	Investigate an anomaly	Edge of a subspace rift	Time runs differently inside
6	Show the flag on a border patrol	Contested asteroid field	A rival ship is shadowing you

Complications (d6, on a natural 2 or when the Admiral needs one): 1 a system fails (roll on the critical table), 2 a crew section is hurt or cut off, 3 a storm or sensor blackout, 4 a third party arrives, 5 supplies spoil (lose 2), 6 orders change mid-mission.

SAMPLE MISSION: SHAKEDOWN CRUISE

- **Requires:** warp drive, impulse engines, sensors. **Helpful:** damage control center.
- **Scenes:** first warp jump (Helm 8), a coolant leak (Engineering 8, three successes before three failures), a test firing at a target drone (Tactical 7).
- **Reward:** 80 FC, 1 Reputation.

SAMPLE MISSION: THE SILENT COLONY

- **Requires:** transporters, sickbay, long-range sensors. **Helpful:** isolation ward, stellar cartography, a shuttle.
- **Scenes:** a colony that stopped answering (Science 8), beaming down through a storm (Operations 10, or a shuttle at 8), a plague with no known cure (Medical 10), a sealed vault under the colony (Engineering or Science 9).
- **Reward:** 200 FC, 2 Reputation, +1 if no away team member is lost.

SAMPLE MISSION: BORDER INCIDENT

- **Requires:** shields, weapons. **Helpful:** diplomatic suites, battle bridge.
- **Scenes:** an unknown ship refuses hails (Diplomacy 9), a standoff at a disputed moon (Command 9; failure becomes a Skirmish), recovering survivors from a wreck (Operations 8).
- **Reward:** 150 FC, 2 Reputation; +2 if no shots are fired.

SKIRMISH

A skirmish is played in rounds of five phases. Most fights between two ships take 6–10 rounds and about 45 minutes.

1. **Power.** Each ship secretly splits its Power points between Engines, Weapons, Shields and Repairs, then reveals. Every 2 points in Engines buys 1" of movement, up to Speed. Each weapon fired costs 1 point (spinal guns cost 3). Each point in Shields restores 1 shield point to any facing. Each point in Repairs adds +1 to damage control.
2. **Movement.** Ships move in Helm order, lowest first, so the best pilot reacts last. Move straight ahead in inches. Turns are 45° and are made between inches: S ships may turn after every inch, M after every 2", L after every 3", XL after every 4".
3. **Fire.** Ships fire in Helm order, highest first. Pick a target in the weapon's arc and range, then roll 2d6 + Tactical: 7+ at short range (up to a third of the weapon's range), 8+ at medium, 10+ at long. Firing more than one weapon at the same target in a round gives the second and later shots +1.
4. **Damage.** Each hit removes shield points from the facing it struck, then marks Hull boxes with what is left. Torpedoes ignore 1 shield point. Every time a hit marks 3 or more Hull boxes, or on a natural 12, roll on the critical table.
5. **Damage control.** Each ship rolls 2d6 + Engineering + Repairs points, target 9. On a success, clear one box on the systems track. Then check Stress.

Critical hits (roll 2d6):

ROLL	SYSTEM HIT	EFFECT WHILE DAMAGED
2	Engineering	Lose 3 Power each round; if the track fills, warp core breach in 1d6 rounds
3–4	Life support	Mark 1 Morale each round
5	Transporters	No boarding, no evacuation
6	Sensors	Tactical rolls at long range fail
7	Weapons	One weapon line cannot fire
8	Shields	One facing drops to 0
9	Small craft	No launch or recovery
10–11	Sickbay	Crew losses double after the fight
12	Bridge	Disadvantage on Helm and Tactical until repaired, unless a battle bridge or auxiliary control is fitted

Stress and overload. Spending more than the ship's Power in a round is allowed: each point over marks 1 Stress box. When the Stress track fills, the spaceframe buckles: mark 1d6 Hull boxes and roll a critical. This is how an overgunned escort plays: devastating for a few rounds, fragile if it keeps pushing.

Separation. Ships built with Two-section or Multi-vector separation may split during the Power phase. Each section gets its own sheet line using the app's section table: Hull, weapons and shields divide by section share, and sections without nacelles have Speed 3 and no FTL.

Victory. A ship is out when its Hull track fills, its crew surrenders (Morale track empty), or it leaves the table. Scenarios can set other goals, such as escorting a freighter across the table or holding a point for 5 rounds.

FOR THE ADMIRAL

The Admiral runs the game: hands out orders, plays everyone the captains meet, and decides what the canon events mean for the fleet. This chapter covers running a first session, campaigns, power levels and Background Ops, and ends with a ready-to-run first mission.

RUNNING YOUR FIRST SESSION

- **Pick the profile and power level.** For a first game: Fleet profile, Line level (800 FC), 2–3 captains.
- **Ships.** Each captain builds a ship in Starship Yard under Build rules → Line, or starts from the cruiser or science template (both under 800 FC). In Launch → Second Watch, they pick a command style and print the record sheet (two pages).
- **Print for the table:** one record sheet per ship, one campaign log per ship, and one set of opponent cards. Blank and sample copies are in the Library.
- **Bring:** three six-sided dice per player, pencils, and a ruler in inches if a fight breaks out. Tokens or 50 mm prints work as miniatures.
- **Optional:** open Launch → Second Watch → Run a mission on a laptop or tablet in the middle of the table. It rolls scenes in the open and checks each ship against the orders.

THE TEN-MINUTE RULES TALK

Read or paraphrase this to the table:

1. **You are captains.** Your crew are skilled professionals; you decide what they attempt. I am the Admiral: I give the orders and play everyone else.
2. **One roll.** Roll two dice and add the roll bonus from your sheet for the department doing the work. Meet the target: 6 is routine, 8 standard, 10 hard, 12 heroic. Your bonus never goes above +4.
3. **Your ship matters.** A facility that fits the job gives advantage (roll three dice, keep the best two). A missing system gives disadvantage (keep the worst two).
4. **Doubles.** Double six is a success with a bonus. Double one always fails and brings a complication.
5. **Resolve.** Each captain has 3 Resolve per mission. Spend one to reroll, or to add +1 after seeing the dice.
6. **Fights.** If talking fails, we put ships on the table and use the Skirmish rules on page 1 of your sheet.

CAMPAIGNS

A campaign links missions with a budget, a fleet and a reputation. The captain and the ship's crew both improve over a campaign, but in different ways.

Fleet Credits (FC). A ship's price is its hull plus what is fitted:

ITEM	COST
Hull	1 FC per 10,000 t of mass (the Explorer is about 520 FC)
Beam weapon (each phaser or beam)	10 FC
Torpedo launcher	15 FC
Shield level	20 FC
Shuttlebay level	15 FC
Facility	10 FC (gym, brig) to 40 FC (holodecks, battle bridge, stellar cartography)

Power level. Before ships are built, the Admiral sets a power level, the way a DM sets a starting level. It is each captain's build budget, and Starship Yard tracks it live (Build rules, at the start of stage 1). Unspent credits become the ship's repair reserve. A **free build** has no limit; the app still shows what the ship would cost.

LEVEL	BUDGET	TYPICAL SHIPS	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THE CAMPAIGN
Patrol	500 FC	Scouts, escorts, couriers	New captains. Every facility is a hard choice; missions are local and small.
Line	800 FC	Cruisers, science ships	The everyday fleet. Room for two or three specialist facilities. The default.
Capital	1,100 FC	Heavy cruisers, carriers	Experienced captains. Raise target numbers or stakes.
Flagship	1,500 FC	Explorers, flagships	Very capable ships. Use for short, high-stakes arcs.
Legend	2,500 FC	Prototypes, one-offs	Showcase games and one-shots. Missions should test choices, not budgets.
Custom	Admiral's choice	Anything	Themed campaigns, such as 600 FC for a fleet rebuilt in a hurry after Wolf 359.

For reference, the app's templates cost about 470 FC (escort), 610 FC (cruiser), 620 FC (science vessel), 890 FC (carrier) and 1,300 FC (explorer). Mixed levels are allowed: one Flagship and two Patrol ships make a natural task force.

Between missions:

- **Pay.** Missions pay 50 to 300 FC and 1 to 3 Reputation, more for optional objectives.
- **Repairs.** 5 FC per Hull box and 20 FC per systems box. Unrepaired damage stays on the sheet.

- **Refit.** Change the design in Starship Yard and pay the price difference plus 25% yard fees. Reprint the record sheet.
- **Fleet.** Buy more ships and send them on separate missions. Decommissioning refunds 40% of the price.
- **Growth.** The captain earns Renown and Command traits. The crew rises in quality as missions are completed. A captain who transfers to a new ship keeps their Renown and traits; the new crew starts Green.
- **Reputation** (0–10) unlocks things: 3 opens the next era of technology, 5 opens new roles (Escort, Carrier), 8 opens prototype facilities in an earlier era.

BACKGROUND OPS: CAMPAIGNS IN CANON'S SHADOW

The shows follow a handful of famous ships. Every canon event also involved hundreds of ships that never appeared on screen. Background Ops campaigns are played by those ships.

Rules of the shadow, for the Admiral:

- **Canon is the weather.** The big events happen as on screen. The captains cannot stop Wolf 359, but they can be the ship that recovers its survivors.
- **The heroes stay offstage.** Famous ships and people appear as messages, orders, rumors and names in reports.
- **The aftermath is the adventure.** Ask what the event left behind: refugees, wreckage, a gap in the patrol line, a treaty that needs enforcing, a secret someone wants buried.
- **Small wins add up.** A campaign may never change canon, but it changes the captains' corner of the galaxy.
- **Divergence is the table's choice.** A group that wants to change history can agree to play an alternate timeline.

ERA	CANON EVENT	CAMPAIGN SEEDS
2150s	Xindi attack on Earth (2153)	Relief convoys; patrols hunting for a second probe; rebuilding defenses with untested ships
2156–60	Earth–Romulan War	Supply runs; holding a line against an unseen enemy; the talks that lead to the Federation
2256–57	Federation–Klingon War	Recovering escape pods after the Binary Stars; holding border colonies; raids behind the lines
2293	Praxis explodes; Khitomer Accords	Humanitarian aid to the Klingons; escorting delegations; a conspiracy against peace
2344	Enterprise-C lost at Narendra III	Searching for survivors; a Klingon world that owes the Federation; Romulan border tension
2367	Wolf 359	Salvage and survivor recovery; quarantining Borg debris; a fleet rebuilding fast
2367–68	Klingon Civil War	Holding the blockade line along the Romulan border; smugglers trying to cross it
2370	Cardassian treaty and the Maquis	Patrolling the Demilitarized Zone; colonists who refuse to leave; friends who joined the Maquis
2371	Voyager lost in the Badlands	Search ships in the Badlands; tracking the Maquis cell; later, supporting efforts to contact it
2373	Borg attack on Sector 001	Clearing debris around Earth; ships with unexplained sensor logs; families of the lost
2373–75	Dominion War	Convoy escort; rear guards; evacuations; the Breen attack on Earth
2385	Attack on Mars and Utopia Planitia	Fighting fires in orbit; rescuing shipyard crews; the synthetic ban and who it hurts
2387	Romulan supernova	A shrinking evacuation; refugees, pirates and hard choices
2401	Frontier Day	Ships not at the review that must hold the line when the fleet turns
3069+	The Burn	Scarce dilithium; colonies cut off; whether the Federation still means anything

Using the table. Each event gives a three-to-five mission arc: the first mission puts the captains on the scene, the middle ones deal with the aftermath, and the last resolves something the shows never mentioned.

Sample arc: Search for Voyager (2371).

1. **Into the Badlands.** Requires shields, sensors. Helpful: astrometrics. Scenes: navigate the plasma storms (Helm 10), find the last ion trail (Science 9), a damaged Maquis raider that may know something (Diplomacy 8, or Tactical 9 to take it).
2. **The Maquis connection.** Requires transporters. Helpful: brig, diplomatic suites. A colony that hides Maquis sympathizers; pressing for answers or earning trust.
3. **Nothing left to find.** One last sweep with anomaly readings no one can explain (Science 10). The captains file the report that helps Starfleet declare the ship lost. Reward: 250 FC, 2 Reputation.

Fleet Command (Generic setting). The Admiral writes 4–6 big events for the setting first (a war, a lost ship, a collapse, a first contact), then plays the ships that history forgot.

FIRST MISSION: THE SALVAGE LINE

Setting (2367, Starfleet skin). One week after the Battle of Wolf 359. One Borg cube destroyed 39 of the 40 ships sent against it. The fleet is rebuilding fast, and the debris field is still full of wreckage, survivors' logs, and Borg technology that must not fall into the wrong hands.

Read aloud (the Admiral's orders):

> Captains, the Wolf 359 debris field is now a restricted zone. Your task force will recover the flight recorders from three of our lost ships, search for survivors in sealed compartments, and collect or destroy any Borg material you find. Ferengi and independent salvagers have already been seen at the edge of the field. You are authorized to warn them off. You are not authorized to start a war over scrap. Admiral out.

Requirements. Sensors and shuttles or small craft. **Helpful:** fabrication shops, damage control center, brig.

SCENE 1: INTO THE FIELD (SCIENCE 8)

The wreckage is dense and some of it is still powered. Each captain chooses a sector. Success: the ship finds a flight recorder and a safe approach. Failure: the ship drifts into a live plasma conduit and marks 2 Hull boxes, but finds the recorder anyway.

SCENE 2: SEALED COMPARTMENT (ENGINEERING 10, OR OPERATIONS 9 WITH A SHUTTLE)

A saucer section has a sealed compartment with faint life signs. Cutting in risks breaching it. Success: four survivors recovered. Failure: the compartment holds, but the rescue takes the rest of the day (lose 1 Supply). On a critical success, one survivor saw something about the cube that Starfleet Intelligence will want.

SCENE 3: BORG MATERIAL (SCIENCE 9, THEN A CAPTAIN'S CHOICE)

One ship finds an intact piece of Borg technology, still faintly active. Roll to contain it safely. Then the captain decides: destroy it now, or bring it home for study. Bringing it home earns +1 Reputation, but the Admiral secretly notes it: it comes back in a later mission.

SCENE 4: THE SALVAGERS (COMMAND 9 OR DIPLOMACY 9)

A Ferengi salvage ship and two independent haulers are cutting up a hull. They insist it is legal salvage. Success: they leave peacefully, or agree to hand over anything Starfleet needs. Failure: the largest hauler opens fire. Run a short Skirmish with the Raider opponent card (one per two player ships), ending when the raiders lose half their Hull.

Twist (Admiral only). One of the flight recorders shows a ship that was ordered away from the battle before it started. Who gave that order is a campaign hook, not something to resolve tonight.

Debrief. At least three scenes succeeded: 160 FC and 2 Reputation per ship, and 1 Renown per captain. Two: 80 FC, no Reputation. Fewer: no pay; the Admiral explains what Starfleet Command thinks of the task force. Each ship marks one completed mission on its campaign log.

Generic skin version. Same structure: the Gate Collapse left a fleet wrecked at a dead jump point. Replace the Borg material with an alien artifact found in the wreckage, and the Ferengi with a corporate salvage crew holding a writ from the seceded shipyards.

AFTER THE SESSION

- Fill in the campaign logs: FC, Reputation, Renown, damage carried, and the twist.
- Repairs cost 5 FC per Hull box and 20 FC per systems box. Unrepaired damage carries over.
- Ask the table which thread they want to pull next: the missing ship from the flight recorder, the Borg material, or the salvagers. That is your second mission.
- Note what felt too easy or too hard, and share it with the person running the playtest.

APPENDIX

QUICK REFERENCE

The roll. 2d6 + roll bonus (never more than +4). Meet or beat: **6** routine · **8** standard · **10** hard · **12** heroic.

Advantage. A facility that fits the job: roll 3d6, keep the best two. **Disadvantage.** A required system missing or damaged: keep the worst two. They cancel out.

Doubles. Double six: success, plus a benefit. Double one: failure, plus a complication.

Pushing. Reroll a failed roll by spending 1 Resolve (3 per mission), or by marking 1 Stress in a fight.

A mission. Orders → Transit → 3 to 5 scenes → Resolution → Debrief. Each Transit and long scene costs 1 Supply.

A skirmish round. 1 Power (split secretly, reveal) → 2 Move (lowest Helm first) → 3 Fire (highest Helm first; 7+ short, 8+ medium, 10+ long) → 4 Damage (shields, then hull; 3+ hull boxes or a 12 = critical) → 5 Damage control (9+ clears a systems box) and Stress check.

Between missions. Repairs 5 FC per Hull box, 20 FC per systems box. Refit: price difference + 25%. Crew: Seasoned after 3 missions, Veteran after 6 more. Captains: every 3 Renown buys a Command trait.

THE GENERIC SETTING

Generic ships use the same rules with their doctrine swapped in: armor belts add Hull boxes equal to their level and reduce every hit by 1 per 3 levels instead of using shields; point defense removes 1 torpedo or missile hit per 2 levels each round; jump drives cross a map edge in one Transit but cost 2 Supplies; sublight-only ships cannot take Transit scenes; spin rings and hydroponics add 1 Morale and 2 Supplies.

Open questions for playtesting:

- Is 2d6 swingy enough, or should big moments use 3d6 drop lowest by default?
- Do L and XL ships turn too slowly on a 3 × 3 ft table?
- Should canon characters ever appear in person, or only as voices and names in reports?
- Is 9 shields per facing on the Explorer too tough against a single escort?
- Do department ratings of +4 leave crew quality and command style with nothing to add?

PRINTABLE SHEETS

Print these from the Library, or make your own ship's from Starship Yard (Launch → Second Watch).

SECOND WATCH · FLEET PROFILE · PAGE 2

U.S.S. ENDEAVOUR NCC-82410

Admiral:

CAPTAIN

Name

Command style **Explorer (+1 Science, Diplomacy)**

Once per mission: Turn a failed Survey or First contact roll into a partial success with a clue.

Resolve (per mission) ☐☐☐

Renown (3 = one trait) ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Command trait

Command trait

Command trait

CREW QUALITY

■ Green +0 ☐ Seasoned +1 ☐ Veteran +2

Missions completed ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Seasoned after 3, Veteran after 6 more. Drop a tier if the ship is lost or Morale hits 0.

FACILITIES (ADVANTAGE SOURCES)

Ready room · Observation lounge · Battle bridge · Main computer core · Secondary computer core · Stellar cartography · Ten Forward · Holodecks · Arboretum · Gymnasium · School and family facilities · Captain's quarters · Diplomatic suites · Intensive care and surgical suite · Isolation ward · Fabrication shops · Damage control center · Antimatter storage pods · Deuterium tankage · Brig · Work bee hangar · Escape pods and lifeboats

ROUND SEQUENCE

1. Power: split points
2. Move: lowest Helm first
3. Fire: highest Helm first
4. Damage: shields, then hull; 3+ hull or a 12 = critical
5. Damage control and Stress check

Core roll: 2d6 + roll bonus vs 6 / 8 / 10 / 12. Advantage 3d6 keep best 2; disadvantage keep worst 2. Double six = critical, double one = complication. Fleet profile. Second Watch rules: https://claude.ai/artifact/8EBgPUT6e1NfrZe2hK4jza

QUICK REFERENCE

1. Roll 2d6 + roll bonus (max +4) vs 6 Routine, 8 Standard, 10 Hard, 12 Heroic
2. Advantage: roll 3d6, keep best 2 (a fitting facility)
3. Disadvantage: keep worst 2 (missing or damaged system)
4. Double six: success plus a benefit. Double one: fail plus a complication
5. Push a failed roll: 1 Stress (in a fight) or 1 Resolve

Mission log

SECOND WATCH · OPPONENT CARDS (STARFLEET SKIN)

RAIDER — SIZE S

Hull	Shields	Power	Speed
10	3	6	9"

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Weapons: Disruptor battery 2×(dmg 2, 18"), forward 180°

Special: Hit and run: may move after firing.

Departments: all +1, Tactical +2. Crew quality Seasoned.

BIRD-OF-PREY TYPE — SIZE S

Hull	Shields	Power	Speed
12	4	8	8"

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Weapons: Disruptor cannons 2×(dmg 2, 18"), torpedo 1×(dmg 4, 24") fore

Special: Cloak: cannot be targeted beyond 12" until it fires.

Departments: all +1, Tactical +2. Crew quality Seasoned.

WARBIRD TYPE — SIZE XL

Hull	Shields	Power	Speed
40	10	22	5"

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

ABOUT THIS PROJECT

Second Watch and Starship Yard are a personal, non-commercial fan project made for a private playtest group. Star Trek and related names are trademarks of their owners; this project is not affiliated with or endorsed by them. The Generic setting contains no Star Trek material.